ULTIMATE X Windows Control - User Manual

Contents

1. Overview
2. System requirements
3. Installation and startup
4. User interface
5. Dashboard
6. Hardware
7. Live Monitor
8. Sensor sources
9. Component test (System Component Test Center)
10. PC report
11. Network
12. Speedtest
13. Network scanner
14. Updates
15. Drivers
16. Programs
17. Startup
18. Processes
19. Benchmarks
20. Clean up storage
21. Desktop Organizer
22. Windows Health
23. Crash analysis
24. Windows Logs
25. Services
26. Security Center
27. Tools & Power
28. Additional layouts
29. Logs
30. Settings
31. Data storage, storage locations, backup
32. Keyboard shortcuts
33. Troubleshooting / FAQ
34. Appendix

Version 1.1.0 · “Your Complete Windows Control Center” · Windows desktop app (WPF, .NET 8)

1. Overview

ULTIMATE X Windows Control is an all-in-one system software for Windows 10 and Windows 11. It combines in a single interface what is otherwise spread across many individual Windows tools: hardware information, live monitoring, diagnostics, repair, network analysis, maintenance and security status.

The app always runs **without administrator rights**. If an action requires admin rights (e.g. a system file repair), Windows asks specifically via User Account Control (UAC). ULTIMATE X never bypasses UAC.

Main features:

Area	What you can do with it
Dashboard	PC condition at a glance, health score, quick actions, Complete PC Check
Hardware	Windows, CPU, GPU, RAM, mainboard/BIOS, monitors, drives incl. SMART, battery
Live Monitor / Sensor sources	Real-time load and temperatures, integration of HWiNFO and LibreHardwareMonitor
Component test	42 safe tests with PASS/WARNING/FAIL, interactive tests (sound, microphone, camera, keyboard …)
PC report	Export the report as PDF or print it, with privacy mode
Network, Speedtest, Network scanner	Adapters, Wi-Fi, DNS, ping, internet speed, devices on the home network
Updates, Drivers, Programs	Windows, driver and software updates (winget), inventory
Startup, Processes	Enable/disable startup entries, running processes with signature verification
Benchmarks	Measure CPU, RAM and drives and compare with previous runs
Clean up storage, Desktop Organizer	Remove temporary files, arrange desktop icons
Windows Health, Crash analysis	SFC, DISM, CHKDSK, memory diagnostics, restore points, blue screen analysis
Services, Windows Logs, Security Center	Overview of services and events, protection status, file signature and hash verification
Tools & Power	CMD/PowerShell, Windows tools, shutdown/restart with countdown

App principles:

- No telemetry. Network access occurs only for the update check (can be disabled) or when you start an action yourself, e.g. a speed test.
- Sensitive data (MAC and IP addresses, serial numbers) is displayed masked by default.
- Many areas are display-only. Changes to the system are made only after confirmation.
- The user interface is bilingual (German/English).

2. System requirements

Requirement	Details
Operating system	Windows 10 64-bit version 1809 (build 17763) or later, or Windows 11 64-bit
Processor architecture	x64
.NET	No separate installation required (the app ships with the runtime)

Rights	Standard user is sufficient; repairs and some actions require administrator approval via UAC

Optional additional programs:

Program	Purpose
HWiNFO (with “Shared Memory Support” enabled) or LibreHardwareMonitor (started as administrator)	real CPU core temperatures and additional sensors
App Installer from the Microsoft Store (winget)	software updates
Debugging Tools for Windows (Windows SDK)	identifying the causing driver for blue screens
Windows Hello (PIN, fingerprint, face)	convenient confirmation of sensitive actions

3. Installation and startup

3.1 Installation

1. Run the installation file `UltimateX-WindowsControl-<Version>-x64.msi`.
2. Accept the license agreement (MIT License).
3. In the feature selection you can
   - change the installation folder (default: `C:\Program Files\ULTIMATE X Windows Control\`),
   - select or deselect the **Desktop shortcut** feature (enabled by default).
4. Confirm the Windows UAC prompt and complete the installation.

A Start menu shortcut **ULTIMATE X Windows Control** is always created in the “ULTIMATE X” folder. The desktop shortcut is named **ULTIMATE X**.

Note: Windows notifications (toasts) only work if the app was installed from the MSI with the Start menu shortcut. Otherwise, notices are displayed within the app.

3.2 Upgrade

A newer version is simply installed over the existing installation; the old version is replaced automatically. Downgrades are blocked – setup then reports “Eine neuere Version von ULTIMATE X Windows Control ist bereits installiert.” (“A newer version of ULTIMATE X Windows Control is already installed.”). In this case, uninstall the existing version first.

3.3 First start

1. Start the app via the Start menu or the desktop shortcut.
2. At startup, ULTIMATE X verifies the signature of its own program files. If the files have been modified, the message “ULTIMATE X – Integrity check” appears and the app does not start for security reasons (see chapter Troubleshooting).
3. On the very first start, the **Welcome to ULTIMATE X** window appears. It explains that the app will now detect the system, hardware, network adapters, software, startup entries and the security and Windows status. Confirm with OK.
4. The dashboard (or the home page of the selected layout) loads the data in the background.
5. Approximately 45 seconds after startup, the app checks for updates in the background, provided this option is enabled in the settings.

3.4 Uninstallation

1. In Windows, open **Settings → Apps** (or “Apps & features”).
2. Select **ULTIMATE X Windows Control** and click **Uninstall**.

Note: According to the project documentation, your personal data under `%LOCALAPPDATA%\UltimateX` (settings, logs, history, backups) is not explicitly removed by the uninstaller. Delete this folder manually if required. A repair function in setup is disabled – reinstall in case of problems.

4. User interface

4.1 Main window layout

The main window “ULTIMATE X Windows Control” consists of:

- **Header (HUD status bar):** logo “ULTIMATE X / Windows Control”, live values for **CPU**, **GPU**, **RAM**, **CPU °C**, **GPU °C** and **NET** (download/upload), Windows version with build, time and date, user and computer name, and the indication “Administrator” or “Standard user”.
- **Search box** “Search (Ctrl+K) …”: jumps to the matching page (see 4.3).
- **Refresh button** (tooltip “Refresh (F5)”): reloads the current page.
- **LOCK button** (tooltip “Lock sensitive areas immediately”): ends the security session immediately (see chapter Settings).
- **Navigation bar (left):** all pages, divided into groups.
- **Content area (right):** the selected page. Status messages and errors are shown directly on the page; the app does not crash on loading errors.

The colors (black/graphite/red in the dark theme) depend on the selected color scheme.

4.2 Navigation

The navigation bar contains the following entries (groups separated by spacing):

Group	Pages
Overview	Dashboard
Hardware & Analysis	Hardware, Live Monitor, Sensor sources, Component test, PC report
Network	Network, Speedtest, Network scanner
Software	Updates, Drivers, Programs, Startup, Processes, Benchmarks
Maintenance	Clean up storage, Desktop Organizer
Windows & Security	Windows Health, Crash analysis, Windows Logs, Services, Security Center
System	Tools & Power, Logs, Settings
Layouts	Gaming Mode, Technician Mode, Visual PC Map, Admin / Service Mode

Click an entry to open the page. Data is loaded when the page is opened for the first time; press F5 or **Refresh** to reload it.

4.3 Global search

1. Press **Ctrl+K** or click in the search box.
2. Enter a term, e.g. “bluescreen”, “winget”, “temperature” or “autostart”.
3. Press **Enter**. The first matching page opens.

The search covers page titles and stored keywords (German and English).

4.4 Layouts

ULTIMATE X offers six layouts, switchable under **Settings → Appearance → Layout**:

Layout	Home page / special feature
Modern Control Center (default)	Dashboard with all navigation entries
Simple Mode	Simplified home page with large tiles, without navigation bar
Gaming Mode	Live performance (CPU, GPU, RAM, VRAM, temperatures, performance history)
Technician Mode	Technical tree view with device IDs, driver data, error codes
Visual PC Map	Graphical map of the components
Admin / Service Mode	Tabs with all technical areas

The layouts Gaming Mode, Technician Mode, Visual PC Map and Admin / Service Mode are additionally accessible at any time via the navigation.

5. Dashboard

The dashboard is the home page in the “Modern Control Center” layout.

5.1 Displays

- **SYSTEM HEALTH / HEALTH SCORE:** ring showing the PC health score, plus PC STATUS, OPERATING SYSTEM, UPTIME, LAST CHECK and RATING.
- **Rings** for CPU, GPU, RAM, VRAM, STORAGE and NETWORK with detail texts (e.g. cores/threads, used memory).
- **TEMPERATURES:** CPU, GPU and other temperatures, if available.
- **LIVE PERFORMANCE · 2 MIN:** history chart of the last two minutes.
- Cards **SECURITY**, **WINDOWS HEALTH**, **NETWORK** (with download/upload gauge and **Start speed test** button) and **UPDATES**.
- **HEALTH SCORE · DETAILS:** The score starts at 100; each deduction is shown with its reason. Values that cannot be measured are not included. The score is a guide, not a guarantee.

Clicking a card opens the associated detail page (e.g. CPU → Hardware, temperatures → Sensor sources, drivers → Drivers).

5.2 Central actions

Button	Function
RUN PC CHECK	Complete system check (read-only)
TEST COMPONENTS	opens the component test (40+ components)
NETWORK TEST	opens the network scanner (ping, devices)
SECURITY CHECK	opens the Security Center and refreshes the status – read-only, no changes
EXPORT REPORT	opens the PC report (PDF, print, preview)
GAME MODE	opens Gaming Mode

5.3 Performing a Complete PC Check

1. Click **RUN PC CHECK** (or in the **COMPLETE PC CHECK** area).
2. Optional: Enable **incl. SFC/DISM (admin rights)** to additionally check the Windows system files. Windows then asks for administrator rights via UAC.
3. Wait until all checks have been completed. The result appears in the COMPLETE PC CHECK area; LAST CHECK is updated.

As long as no check has been run in the current session, it reads: “No check in this session yet”.

5.4 Quick access

Under **QUICK ACCESS** you will find: **Check Windows**, **Cleanup**, **Organize desktop**, **Empty recycle bin**, **CMD**, **PowerShell**, **Lock PC**, **Restart**, **Sleep**, **Shut down**.

Warning: **Empty recycle bin** permanently deletes all items. The app first displays the number and size and requires confirmation. This cannot be undone.

5.5 Exporting raw data

1. Click **Raw data (TXT/JSON) …**.
2. Optional: Enable **sensitive data** if IP/MAC addresses and serial numbers are to be included (requires confirmation).
3. Select the storage location and format (text file or JSON). Default name: `UltimateX-Bericht-<Datum>-<Zeit>`.

6. Hardware

The page shows only components that Windows actually reports: system information (Windows, CPU, GPU with VRAM, RAM modules, mainboard/BIOS/UEFI, TPM, Secure Boot, battery), **Monitors** (with **Primary monitor** indicator, resolution, Hz, HDR, scaling), **Drives** and a **Hardware topology**.

Re-reading data: Click **Detect again**.

Reading the SMART values of the drives:

1. Click **Read SMART details (admin rights)**.
2. Confirm the UAC prompt.
3. Temperature, operating hours, service life and errors appear for the drives. The values are cached and also used by other pages (e.g. Visual PC Map, Component test).

Note: Occupied or free PCIe and M.2 slots cannot be reliably determined via Windows and are therefore not displayed.

7. Live Monitor

Shows live charts for CPU, GPU, RAM, VRAM, drives and download/upload.

1. Under **Period:**, select **60 seconds**, **5 minutes** or **15 minutes**.
2. The **Sensors** area shows available temperature and fan values.
3. The **Real CPU temperatures?** button explains how to obtain CPU core temperatures via HWiNFO or LibreHardwareMonitor.

GPU load, VRAM and GPU temperature come from the Windows graphics kernel (as in Task Manager) and work with AMD, Intel and NVIDIA, provided a current driver (WDDM 2.4+) is installed.

8. Sensor sources

ULTIMATE X deliberately does not load its own kernel driver. Real CPU core temperatures are therefore taken from other programs. The sources are used in this priority (automatic failover):

1. HWiNFO
2. LibreHardwareMonitor
3. Windows native
4. ACPI (thermal zones, displayed as “Mainboard”, not as CPU)

ACTIVE SOURCES area: status per source (CONNECTED, AVAILABLE, INACTIVE, NOT AVAILABLE), number of sensors and “Last update”.

UNIFIED SENSOR MODEL area: table with the columns Sensor, Name, Hardware, Current, Min, Ø, Max, Source, As of.

Viewing sensor details: Select a sensor in the table. Under **SENSOR DETAILS**, MIN, Ø, MAX, source and a history graph appear.

Resetting statistics: Min/Ø/Max are calculated since program start. Use **Reset min/avg/max** to start over.

Setting up HWiNFO (Setup button):

1. Start HWiNFO.
2. Enable **Shared Memory Support** in the HWiNFO settings.
3. Keep the HWiNFO sensor window open.

Note: In the free version of HWiNFO, a time limit imposed by HWiNFO itself applies to Shared Memory. LibreHardwareMonitor must run as administrator, otherwise it does not deliver any values.

9. Component test (System Component Test Center)

9.1 Testing all components

1. Open **Component test** (or Dashboard → **TEST COMPONENTS**).
2. Click **TEST ALL SYSTEM COMPONENTS**.
3. The tests run one after another; click **Cancel** to stop the run.

4. The summary shows TOTAL and the number of **PASS**, **WARNING**, **FAIL**, **NOT AVAILABLE** and **USER ACTION**.
5. Click a test to see the reason under **DETAILS**.

42 areas are tested, including CPU, RAM, GPU, VRAM, NVMe/SSD/HDD, mainboard, BIOS/UEFI, TPM, Secure Boot, Ethernet, Wi-Fi, DNS, gateway, internet, Bluetooth, USB, audio, microphone, speakers, camera, monitors, keyboard, mouse, battery, sensors, fans, services, Windows Update, Defender, firewall, event log, WMI, Windows Search, printers, storage controllers, GPU and chipset drivers, system time and WinRE.

Status	Meaning
PASS	OK
WARNING	anomaly, check recommended
FAIL	error detected
NOT AVAILABLE	not present or cannot be checked
NOT TESTED	not tested (yet)
USER ACTION REQUIRED	requires your involvement (e.g. interactive test, reading SMART)

By default, only safe, non-destructive checks are performed.

Note: The GPU test does not include a render or stress test.

9.2 Optional write test

Under **WRITE TEST** (“Optional, only after confirmation”), a drive can be checked for writability using a dedicated temporary test file. The app asks beforehand (“Optional write test”).

9.3 Interactive tests

These tests run only when clicked. Nothing is recorded or saved.

Button	Procedure
PLAY TEST SOUND	A tone plays on the left, on the right and on both sides. The app then asks whether you heard everything.
MICROPHONE LEVEL START / STOP	Displays the live level and peak (no recording). Click again to stop.
CHECK CAMERA	After confirmation, the camera is opened briefly and released immediately, without an image.
DISPLAY COLOR TEST	Full-screen colors; afterwards a question about pixel defects, stripes or brightness differences.
KEYBOARD & MOUSE TEST	Separate test window for keys and mouse.
PRINT WINDOWS TEST PAGE	After confirmation, prints a test page on the default printer; afterwards a question as to whether it printed correctly.
WINDOWS MEMORY DIAGNOSTIC	Starts Windows Memory Diagnostic; the test runs at the next restart (approx. 15–30 minutes).

Warning: Windows Memory Diagnostic requires a restart. Save all open work beforehand. The result appears in the event log after the restart and subsequently in the RAM test.

Camera and microphone require the Windows privacy permission for desktop apps.

9.4 History and export

- Under **TEST HISTORY** you can see previous runs with a comparison to the previous run.
- Use **Export report (TXT/JSON)** to save the result (default name `UltimateX-Komponententest-<Datum>-<Zeit>`).

10. PC report

Creates a formatted PC report (A4) with branding, overview, health score, hardware cards, tables, status indicators, warnings, charts, report date, report ID and app version.

10.1 Exporting the report as PDF

1. Open **PC report** (or Dashboard → **EXPORT REPORT**).
2. Under **SECTIONS**, select the desired parts: Hardware, Sensors, Network, Security, Drivers, Windows Health, Component tests, Benchmarks, Crash analysis.
3. If component test data is missing, you can start a run with **Run component test now**.
4. Check the preview ("This report contains: …").
5. Click **EXPORT PC REPORT (PDF)** and select the storage location (default name `UltimateX-PC-Bericht-<Datum>-<Zeit>.pdf`).

10.2 Printing the report

1. Steps 1–4 as above.
2. Click **PRINT PC REPORT**. The Windows print dialog opens; "Microsoft Print to PDF" can also be selected there.

Collect data again re-reads all data for the report.

10.3 Privacy mode

Under **PRIVACY**, **Privacy mode (recommended)** is enabled by default. It masks IP and MAC addresses, user and computer name, serial numbers and gateway/DNS. Disabling it requires confirmation via Windows Hello; if you cancel, the mode remains active.

Warning: A report without privacy mode contains identifying data. Share it only with trusted people.

11. Network

Shows network adapters (IPv4/IPv6, gateway, DNS, DHCP, MAC masked) and Wi-Fi details (SSID, signal, band, channel, Wi-Fi standard, rates, security).

Button	Function
Analyze network	Multi-step network diagnosis (including HTTPS connection to www.microsoft.com)
Test DNS	A query of www.microsoft.com per DNS server
Query public IP	Query via ipify.org (HTTPS), only after confirmation
Refresh	Reload data
Copy MAC	copies the MAC address of an adapter

Ping: Select **Gateway**, **1.1.1.1** or **8.8.8.8** as the target. 10 pings are sent (**Ping (10×)**); minimum, maximum, average and packet loss are displayed.

Note: On Windows 11 (24H2 and later), the Wi-Fi view shows the SSID only if location access for apps is allowed.

12. Speedtest

1. Click **Start speed test**.
2. The first time, the **Data usage notice** appears: depending on the connection, a test transfers approx. 100 MB to over 1 GB. Measurement is performed via HTTPS against speed.cloudflare.com. Confirm to continue.
3. The test measures download, upload, ping and jitter (gauge display). Click **Cancel** to end it prematurely.
4. **Last result** shows the most recent measurement; **Comparison** shows the averages of the **Last 7 days** and **Last 30 days**; **History** lists all measurements with date.

Warning: On mobile or data-capped connections, the speed test may incur costs.

13. Network scanner

13.1 Scanning the home network

1. Click **Scan network**. The address range is shown under **Network:**.
2. The first time, confirm that you only scan your own networks (not corporate or hotel Wi-Fi).
3. The device list shows IP address, type, name, vendor, MAC and ping. Newly added devices are marked **NEW**.
4. Click **Cancel** to stop the scan.

Only your own private network (e.g. 192.168.x.x) is scanned.

13.2 Actions per device

Button	Function
PING	Send and evaluate 4 pings
LIVE PING	continuous ping with live chart, **STOP** ends it
DETAILS	show DEVICE DETAILS (incl. link to the web interface, if available)
SERVICES	check common services (only when clicked) with security notes
COPY IP / COPY MAC	copy the address to the clipboard
Custom label + Save	give the device a custom name

The ping evaluation shows the status (reachable / unstable / not reachable), SENT, RECEIVED, LOSS, JITTER as well as MIN, Ø, MAX.

13.3 QUICK PING

1. In the **QUICK PING** field, enter an IP address, a host name or a local name (e.g. `192.168.178.1`, `fritz.box`, `drucker.local`).
2. Select the mode **1×**, **4×**, **10×** or **Continuous**.
3. Click **PING** or **LIVE PING**; **STOP** ends a continuous ping.

Note: A continuous ping only runs while the page is open.

13.4 Additional functions

- **Load vendor list (IEEE):** After confirmation, downloads the official MAC vendor list (approx. 4 MB) via HTTPS and stores it locally. Vendors are then recognized.
- **Forget known devices:** Deletes the list of known devices and all custom labels.

14. Updates

The page combines four update sources. **Check everything again** searches all of them again; **Open Windows Update** opens the Windows settings.

Driver updates (Windows Update): Only Microsoft-signed drivers for the hardware ID of this PC.

1. Click **Search**.
2. Click **Install** for an entry.
3. Confirm (Windows Hello, if set up) and confirm the UAC prompt. A restore point is requested beforehand (if enabled in the settings).

Rollback: Device Manager → device properties → Driver → “Roll Back Driver”.

Windows updates: Search, then **Install** individually.

Software updates (winget): List of programs that can be updated via winget. Update individual programs with **Update**, all in sequence with **Update all** (each with a confirmation prompt). The winget output appears in the **Output** area.

ULTIMATE X: Check for app update and **Install update**. Updates are downloaded via HTTPS only and executed only after successful SHA-256 and signature verification (same certificate as the installed version).

Note: App updates only work if an update source (publisher’s HTTPS manifest) is configured in the settings. By default, the field is empty, i.e. no app update check takes place. Unsigned builds never update themselves.

Warning: Updates modify the system. Save open work; driver and Windows updates may require a restart.

15. Drivers

List of all drivers with device, class, manufacturer, version, date, **New version** (from Windows Update), source, signed, signed by and INF file.

- **Filter by device, manufacturer, class:** search box above the list.
- **Important device classes only:** hides less relevant devices.
- **Search for driver updates:** checks Windows Update for new drivers.
- **Windows Update** and **Device Manager** open the respective Windows tools.

Drivers are installed exclusively via Windows Update (Updates page). For the latest graphics drivers, use the official NVIDIA, AMD or Intel websites.

16. Programs

List of installed programs with name, publisher, version, size, installation date and scope (user/all users).

- **Filter by name or publisher**
- **Open install folder:** opens the folder of the selected program.
- **Uninstall …:** opens “Apps & features” in the Windows settings. Select the program there and uninstall it. For security reasons, ULTIMATE X does not perform the uninstallation itself.

17. Startup

List of programs that start with Windows: Active, name, **system-relevant** indicator, publisher, signature, source, path.

Disabling or enabling an entry:

1. Toggle the switch in the **Active** column.
2. For entries for all users, confirm the UAC prompt.

Entries are never deleted, only enabled/disabled as in Task Manager. A backup is created automatically before every change.

Restoring a backup: Click **Restore last backup** and confirm. The entries of your user are restored. **Open backups** shows the backup folder.

Warning: Do not disable entries marked as system-relevant (e.g. security software, driver utilities) if you do not know their purpose.

18. Processes

Display-only view of the running processes with name, PID, CPU, RAM, publisher, signature and path.

- **Filter by name, path or publisher**
- **Verify signatures:** verifies the digital signature of the program files.
- **Folders:** opens the location of a process.

A missing signature does not mean that a process is malicious – use Windows Security for an assessment.

19. Benchmarks

All tests run locally without additional software. The scores are used for comparison with previous runs on this PC (e.g. after driver updates or upgrades), not with online rankings.

1. Close as many other programs as possible.
2. Select a test:
   - **Test CPU:** single/multi-core, integer, floating point, crypto.
   - **Test RAM:** bandwidth and latency (temporarily occupies up to 512 MB).
   - **Test drive:** select drive and test size (**256 MB (fast)**, **1 GB (more accurate)**, **4 GB (outsmart SSD cache)**); a test file is written, read and deleted again.
3. Confirm the prompt. **Cancel** stops the test.
4. Results appear as cards with scores and in the **History** (time, test, score, details) with a comparison to the last run.

20. Clean up storage

Only fixed locations defined by Windows as temporary are cleaned. Documents, Desktop, Downloads and Pictures are never affected.

Category	Note
Temporary files (user)	only files older than 24 hours
Temporary files (Windows)	only files older than 24 hours; without admin rights only your own files
Thumbnail cache	is recreated by Windows
Windows error reports	archived and queued reports
DirectX shader cache	is rebuilt; first game start may be slightly slower
Recycle bin	deleted files of all drives

Procedure:

1. Click **Analyze again**. The number of files, size and paths are displayed per category.
2. Select the desired categories (recommended ones are preselected).
3. Click **Clean selected**.
4. Check the summary and confirm. For the recycle bin, an additional confirmation (Windows Hello) is required.
5. The result shows deleted files, freed space and skipped (locked) files.

Windows Storage Sense opens the Windows storage settings.

Warning: Deleted files are permanently removed and do not go to the recycle bin. Emptying the recycle bin cannot be undone.

21. Desktop Organizer

Arranges desktop icons by type. Only positions are changed – no file is moved, renamed or deleted. The layout is saved before every change.

Prerequisite: “Auto arrange icons” must be disabled (right-click on the desktop → View).

Organizing the desktop:

1. Under **Arrangement**, select:
   - **Sort order: A – Z** or **Z – A**
   - **Screen side: Start on the left** or **Start on the right**
   - **Gap between groups: None**, **1 column**, **2 columns**
2. Click **Refresh preview** to check the arrangement.
3. Click **Organize desktop now** and confirm.

Undoing: Restore last desktop layout and confirm.

Custom rules:

1. Under **Rules (order = arrangement on the desktop)** you can see the categories with file extensions.
2. **Add category** creates a new category. Enter file extensions separated by spaces (e.g. `.pdf .docx`).
3. **Remove** deletes a category, **Default** restores the default rules.
4. Click **Save rules**.

A category named “Folders” collects all folders. Unassigned files go to “Other”; system icons (Recycle Bin, This PC) are placed at the very beginning.

22. Windows Health

All tools run through a fixed command list and the signed admin helper. Windows asks for administrator rights via UAC each time. Before starting, an explanation with confirmation appears (Windows Hello, if applicable).

Warning: System repairs intervene deeply in Windows. Save open work and do not interrupt running repairs by switching off the PC.

22.1 System files and component store

Button	Function	Duration
Check system files (SFC)	checks protected system files and replaces corrupted ones	approx. 5–20 min
Quick Check	DISM CheckHealth, no changes	short
Deep Scan	DISM ScanHealth, no changes	approx. 5–15 min
Windows Repair	DISM RestoreHealth, repairs using files from Windows Update, requires internet	approx. 10–30 min
Repair workflow (DISM → SFC)	runs both in sequence	correspondingly longer

Procedure:

1. Click the desired button.
2. Read the explanation and confirm.
3. Confirm the UAC prompt.
4. Progress and summary appear on the page. **Show technical output** displays the original output. **Stop display** ends the display.

Before **Windows Repair**, a restore point is requested automatically (if enabled).

22.2 Disk (CHKDSK)

1. Select the drive.
2. **Check (read-only):** checks the file system online, without repair.
3. **Repair …:** repairs errors found (`/spotfix`). For the system drive, the repair is scheduled for the next restart.

Warning: During a repair, the drive may be unavailable briefly. Close all files on this drive beforehand.

22.3 Memory

Windows Memory Diagnostic … starts Windows Memory Diagnostic. In the subsequent Windows dialog, choose whether to restart immediately or at the next start.

22.4 Recovery

- **Create restore point:** creates a point after confirmation. Windows creates at most one point per 24 hours.
- **Open System Restore:** opens the Windows tool (admin rights).

22.5 Additional displays

- Restart status (“Restart required” / “No restart required”) and active hours; **Open Windows Update**. ULTIMATE X never disables Windows Update.
- **Stability (30 days):** counted Windows events (e.g. crashes).
- **Important Windows services** with status.
- **Most frequent problems (event logs, 7 days).**

23. Crash analysis

1. Under **Period (days):**, select the time period.
2. The page shows:
   - **Blue screens** with plain-text explanation, recommendation, parameters and source,
   - **Hardware errors (WHEA)**,
   - **Program crashes and hanging programs** (program, type, count, last, module, code).
3. **Reliability history** opens the Windows tool; **Test RAM** starts the memory diagnostic.

Analyzing minidumps:

1. Click **Read crash dumps (admin)** and confirm the UAC prompt. The **Crash dumps (minidumps)** list shows file, time, size, code and error.
2. Select a dump and click **Find cause**. If the Microsoft debugger (Debugging Tools for Windows) is installed, the causing driver is identified; the **Original debugger output** can be viewed. Without the debugger, the message “Debugger not installed” appears.

24. Windows Logs

Shows entries of the **System**, **Application** and **Setup** event logs with time, level, source, event ID and message. **incl. warnings** additionally shows warnings; **Refresh** reloads.

25. Services

Display-only view of all Windows services with display name, name, status, startup type, account and path. Filters: **Filter by name**, **Running only**.

Services with startup type “Automatic” that are not running are highlighted in orange – this is normal for delayed or trigger start. Make changes via the Windows Services console.

Warning: Changing services in Windows can impair system functions. Only change services whose function you know.

26. Security Center

Shows (read-only) the status of Defender or third-party antivirus, firewall, Secure Boot, TPM, BitLocker, UAC and app integrity. ULTIMATE X never changes or disables these protection features; BitLocker recovery keys are never read. A green status means “protection feature active” – not that the PC is invulnerable.

Buttons: **Open Windows Security**, **Firewall settings**, **Refresh**.

Checking a file (signature and hash):

1. Click **Select file …** and select a file (e.g. .exe, .dll, .msi, .sys).
2. Optional: Enable **Also MD5 (legacy, not secure)**.
3. Size, signature status, publisher, certificate thumbprint and hash values (SHA-256) are displayed.

The file is only read, never executed. Windows system files are often catalog-signed and therefore show “No embedded signature”.

27. Tools & Power

27.1 Power

Button	Function
Shut down	with confirmation and countdown
Restart	with confirmation and countdown
Sleep	standby, with confirmation
Lock	lock screen

Sign out	with confirmation
Cancel scheduled shutdown	cancels a running countdown

Warning: Save all work before shutting down, restarting or signing out. Unsaved data in other programs may be lost.

27.2 Windows tools

Command Prompt, CMD (administrator), PowerShell, PowerShell (administrator), Windows Terminal (if installed), Task Manager, Device Manager, Disk Management, System information, Windows Update, Network adapters, Firewall settings, Windows Security, Apps & features, Storage settings, System Restore, Location privacy, Reliability history.

Tools marked **UAC** require confirmation (Windows Hello, if set up) and administrator approval by Windows.

Warning: Commands executed in an administrator console can modify the system.

28. Additional layouts

28.1 Simple Mode

Simplified home page with the tiles **Check PC**, **Test internet**, **Search for updates**, **Clean up storage**, **Tidy up desktop**, **Manage startup**, **Check Windows**, **Restart**, **Sleep**. From subpages, ‹ **Back to home** returns to the home page. **Switch to advanced view** switches to the Modern Control Center.

28.2 Gaming Mode

Large live tiles for CPU, GPU, RAM (including load, VRAM, temperatures) and **PERFORMANCE HISTORY · 2 MIN**.

28.3 Technician Mode

Tree view with Windows, Mainboard, CPU, Memory, GPU, Storage, Network, USB and Drivers (with the number of problem devices). For each device, status/error code, class, manufacturer, device ID, hardware IDs, driver version, date, provider and signature are displayed. The “Diagnosis” node lists the admin commands executed in this session (“No admin commands in this session yet” if empty).

28.4 Visual PC Map

Graphical map with CPU, GPU, RAM, storage, monitors, USB, network, internet, etc. Click a component for details; the tooltip shows device, load, temperature and status. **Open Technician Mode** switches to the technical view.

28.5 Admin / Service Mode

Tabs: Hardware, Drivers, Processes, Services, Startup, Network, Storage, Windows Logs, Diagnostics, Security, Export. The tabs correspond to the pages of the same name.

Export tab:

- **Export system report (TXT/JSON) …** – Windows, CPU, GPU, RAM, mainboard, storage, network, drivers, updates, startup, health. With **Include sensitive data (requires confirmation)**, masked data is included.
- **Export action and security log (TXT/JSON) …**

29. Logs

Shows the app’s action and security log with time, level, area, action, message and details.

- **Security events only:** filters for security-relevant entries (e.g. admin actions).
- **Export (TXT/JSON) …:** saves the entries (default name `UltimateX-Log-<Datum>-<Zeit>`).
- **Open folder:** opens the log folder.

30. Settings

Open **Settings** in the navigation. Changes are saved immediately.

30.1 Appearance

Option	Values
Color scheme	System (default), Dark, Light
Layout	Modern Control Center (default), Gaming Mode, Technician Mode, Visual PC Map, Simple Mode, Admin / Service Mode
Language	Automatic (Windows language; German, otherwise English), Deutsch, English

The language takes effect after restarting the app – use **Restart app** for this.

Note: Some rare messages may remain in German in the English interface.

30.2 Security

- **Mask sensitive data (MAC, IP, serial numbers):** on by default. Disabling requires confirmation via Windows Hello.
- **Security session after successful confirmation: Always ask again** (default), **1 minute**, **2 minutes**, **5 minutes**. Within this time, sensitive actions do not need to be confirmed again.

The session ends immediately when the PC is locked, on sign-out, on user switch and via the **LOCK** button. ULTIMATE X itself never asks for passwords or PINs; confirmation is done via Windows Hello. If Windows Hello is not set up, your explicit confirmation in the dialog counts as approval.

30.3 Startup & Power

- **Start with Windows:** adds the app to your user's startup.
- **Start minimized:** the app starts minimized.
- **Countdown before restart/shutdown:** on/off, duration **10 s**, **30 s** (default) or **60 s**.

30.4 Notifications & updates

- **Windows notifications** (updates, disk space, temperature, repairs, security) – default: on.
- **Create a restore point before driver updates and system repairs** – default: on.
- **Check for updates in the background at startup (Windows Update, winget, ULTIMATE X)** – default: on.
- **Update source for ULTIMATE X (publisher's HTTPS manifest)** with **Save**. Empty = no update check. Only HTTPS addresses are accepted; a change requires confirmation.

30.5 About

Product information and **Open data folder** (opens `%LOCALAPPDATA%\UltimateX`).

31. Data storage, storage locations, backup

All user data remains local on the PC.

Location / file	Content
`C:\Program Files\ULTIMATE X Windows Control\`	Program files (`UltimateX.exe`, `UltimateX.AdminHelper.exe`, etc.)
`%LOCALAPPDATA%\UltimateX\settings.json`	Settings
`%LOCALAPPDATA%\UltimateX\logs\`	Logs (`app-<Datum>.jsonl`, `security-<Datum>.jsonl`)
`%LOCALAPPDATA%\UltimateX\backups\`	Startup backups (`startup-*.json`), desktop layouts (`desktop-*.json`)
`%LOCALAPPDATA%\UltimateX\history.db`	History database (SQLite); entries older than approx. 1 year are removed automatically
`%LOCALAPPDATA%\UltimateX\speedtest-history.json`	Speed test history

`%LOCALAPPDATA%\UltimateX\ComponentTests\history.json`	Component test history
`%LOCALAPPDATA%\UltimateX\desktop-rules.json`	Desktop Organizer rules
`%LOCALAPPDATA%\UltimateX\smart-cache.json`	cached SMART values
`%LOCALAPPDATA%\UltimateX\oui.csv`	IEEE vendor list (after download)
`%ProgramData%\UltimateX\HelperRuns`	folder created by the installer for the admin helper

Data backup: To back up settings and history, copy the `%LOCALAPPDATA%\UltimateX` folder to a safe location while the app is closed. To restore, copy it back.

Automatic backups: Before every startup change and every desktop rearrangement, the app itself creates a backup in the `backups` folder.

Corrupted settings: If `settings.json` is corrupted, the app renames it to `settings.json.broken-<Zeitstempel>` and starts with default values.

32. Keyboard shortcuts

Shortcut	Function
Ctrl+K	Activate search box
Enter (in search box)	open matching page
F5	refresh current page

33. Troubleshooting / FAQ

Installation and startup

Problem	Solution
“Eine neuere Version … ist bereits installiert” (“A newer version … is already installed”)	Downgrades are blocked. Uninstall the older version first under Settings → Apps.
App does not start, message “Integrity check”	Program files have been modified. Reinstall the MSI.
“Admin helper not found”	Reinstall; `UltimateX.AdminHelper.exe` must be located next to `UltimateX.exe`.
“Sichere Verbindung zum Admin-Helper konnte nicht hergestellt werden”	Security software is blocking the internal connection, or the app was started from an unusual folder. Start the app from the installation folder.
“Ausgabe des Admin-Helpers aus Sicherheitsgründen verworfen”	A security check failed. The command was nevertheless executed; the result can be checked in Windows (e.g. `%windir%\Logs\CBS\CBS.log`).
Resetting settings	Close the app, delete `%LOCALAPPDATA%\UltimateX\settings.json`.
“An unexpected error occurred”	The error has been logged. Details under Logs or in the log folder.

Sensors and temperatures

Problem	Solution
HWiNFO “NOT AVAILABLE”	HWiNFO is not running (optional).
HWiNFO “INACTIVE”	Enable “Shared Memory Support” in HWiNFO and keep the sensor window open.
LibreHardwareMonitor “INACTIVE”	Start LibreHardwareMonitor as administrator.
No GPU temperature	Install a current graphics driver (WDDM 2.4+); some integrated

	GPUs do not report a temperature.
No CPU temperature without additional program	By design – see chapter Sensor sources.
Min/Ø/Max appear incorrect	On the Sensor sources page, “Reset min/avg/max”.

Network

Problem	Solution
Wi-Fi shows no SSID	Windows Settings → Privacy → Location → “Let apps access your location” (or Tools & Power → Location privacy).
Device “NOT REACHABLE” although it is running	Many devices do not respond to ping. Check with “SERVICES”.
Host name is not resolved	Local names require the router as DNS or mDNS/LLMNR. Use the IP address.
Live ping stops when changing pages	By design.

Component tests

Problem	Solution
Camera “Zugriff blockiert” (access blocked)	Windows Settings → Privacy → Camera → allow desktop apps access.
Microphone “kein Signal” (no signal)	Check mute, default recording device and privacy permission.
System time “NOT AVAILABLE”	UDP port 123 (NTP) blocked or no internet.
WinRE “NOT AVAILABLE”	Cannot be read without admin rights; check with `reagentc /info` in an admin console.
SMART “not read yet”	Hardware page → “Read SMART details (admin rights)”.
Write test “nicht möglich” (not possible)	No write permissions or insufficient space.

PC report

Problem	Solution
Privacy mode cannot be switched off	Disabling requires Windows Hello or confirmation; if canceled, it remains on.
Section missing	Section deactivated in the preview or no data yet (e.g. no component test).

Repair, updates, maintenance

Problem	Solution
SFC “could not perform the requested operation”	Restart (pending updates), then try again.
DISM RestoreHealth error 0x800f081f	Check the internet connection and Windows Update.
winget missing	Install “App Installer” from the Microsoft Store.
Windows Hello does not appear	Set up Hello in the Windows settings; without Hello, explicit confirmation is used.
Desktop Organizer reports “Auto arrange icons”	Right-click on the desktop → View → disable “Auto arrange icons”.
No Windows notifications	Install the app via the MSI (Start menu shortcut required) and check the option in the settings.
Undoing a driver update	Device Manager → device → Properties → Driver → “Roll Back Driver”.

FAQ

- *Does ULTIMATE X send data to the internet?* No, no telemetry. Connections are only made for update checks and actions that you trigger yourself (speed test, public IP, vendor list, network diagnosis).
- *Do I need administrator rights?* No, only for individual actions; Windows then asks via UAC.
- *Can the app damage my PC?* Most pages are display-only. Intervening actions (repairs, cleanup, updates, startup) require confirmation; restore points or backups are created before major interventions.

34. Appendix

34.1 Glossary

Term	Explanation
UAC	Windows User Account Control; asks for administrator approval
Windows Hello	Sign-in via PIN, fingerprint or face; used here to confirm sensitive actions
Security Session	Period in which no further confirmation is required after a confirmation
Admin helper	separate helper program that executes admin actions from a fixed command list
SFC	System File Checker – checks Windows system files
DISM	Tool for checking and repairing the Windows component store
CHKDSK	Checking and repairing the file system
SMART	Self-diagnosis of hard drives and SSDs
WHEA	Windows hardware error reports
Minidump	Crash dump after a blue screen
winget	Windows package manager for software updates
TPM / Secure Boot	Security features of mainboard and firmware
WinRE	Windows Recovery Environment
Jitter	Variation in ping times
OUI / IEEE list	Mapping of MAC addresses to vendors
Health Score	Overall rating of the PC condition (starts at 100, deductions with reason)

34.2 File formats

Format	Usage
PDF	PC report
TXT / JSON	System report, component test report, log export
JSONL	internal log files (one line per entry)
JSON	Settings, backups, history
SQLite (.db)	History database
CSV	IEEE vendor list

34.3 External addresses

Address	Purpose
https://speed.cloudflare.com	Speed test
https://api.ipify.org / https://api6.ipify.org	public IP
https://standards-oui.ieee.org/oui/oui.csv	MAC vendor list

https://www.microsoft.com	Reachability test in the network diagnosis

34.4 License

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